

Erosion

Erosion is the wearing away of rocks and other matter on the Earth's surface by a natural force, such as a sliding glacier, a flowing river, or the wind. Material that is rubbed off is carried away and deposited somewhere else.



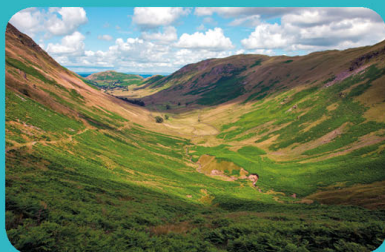
Water erosion

This is caused by falling rain or flowing water. Rivers, for example, wear away the land that they flow over, changing the surrounding landscape.



Wind erosion

The force of the wind can remove pieces of rock and carry them off. Wind erosion is common in deserts.



Ice erosion

As glaciers move, they rub away the land under them, carrying the broken-down material with them.



Coastal erosion

Crashing waves gradually wear away the rock in cliffs, and sweep up material from the beach.